IOP and PHP group topics: 78 session ideas

For adult mental health groups. Every topic stands alone, so it works when members join on different days. The last column is for your own run dates. Codes match Volume 1 of the Open-Enrollment Program Series.

Process groups

1	Arriving	PR-01	
2	Carrying the Week	PR-02	
3	The Mask and the Mirror	PR-03	
4	Frustration and Stuckness	PR-04	
5	Trust and Safety Here	PR-05	
6	The Inner Critic	PR-06	
7	Grief, Loss, and What Changed	PR-07	
8	Hope and Doubt	PR-08	
9	Connection and Isolation	PR-09	
10	Resilience and Quiet Wins	PR-10	
11	Giving and Receiving Feedback	PR-11	
12	Anger and Boundaries	PR-12	
13	Shame and Self-Forgiveness	PR-13	
14	Identity Beyond the Diagnosis	PR-14	
15	Navigating Outside Relationships	PR-15	
16	Setbacks and Recovery Momentum	PR-16	
17	Preparing for Transition / Stepping Down	PR-17	
18	Endings, Goodbyes, and Continuity	PR-18	

Skills groups

MINDFULNESS			
19	Observe and Describe	SK-MF-01	
20	Grounding When Overwhelmed	SK-MF-02	
21	Attention Training	SK-MF-03	
EMOTION REGULATION			
22	Emotions, Urges, and Actions	SK-ER-01	
23	Check the Facts and Opposite Action	SK-ER-02	
24	Reducing Emotional Vulnerability	SK-ER-03	
DISTRESS TOLERANCE			
25	Crisis Survival Skills	SK-DT-01	
26	Radical Acceptance and Turning the Mind	SK-DT-02	
27	Self-Soothing with the Senses and a Distraction Plan	SK-DT-03	
THOUGHTS (CBT AND ACT)			
28	The Thought-Feeling-Behavior Connection and Common Thinking Traps	SK-CG-01	
29	Examining the Evidence and Thought Reframing	SK-CG-02	
30	Cognitive Defusion and Noticing Hooked Thoughts	SK-CG-03	

BEHAVIORAL ACTIVATION

31	Activity Scheduling and the Pleasure-Mastery Balance	SK-BA-01	
32	Values-Based Action and Overcoming Avoidance	SK-BA-02	
33	Graded Task Assignment and Habit Stacking	SK-BA-03	

INTERPERSONAL EFFECTIVENESS

34	Objective Effectiveness and Assertive Communication	SK-IE-01	
35	Relationship Effectiveness and Boundary Setting	SK-IE-02	
36	Self-Respect Effectiveness and Saying No	SK-IE-03	

Psychoeducation groups

37	Understanding Depression	PE-01	
38	Understanding Anxiety and the Fight-or-Flight Response	PE-02	
39	Chronic Stress and Recovery Time	PE-03	
40	The Panic Cycle and Interoceptive Conditioning	PE-04	
41	Sleep and Mood	PE-05	
42	Strong Emotions and Making Room to Pause	PE-06	
43	The Window of Tolerance and Autonomic Regulation	PE-07	
44	Understanding Trauma, Triggers, and the Nervous System	PE-08	
45	Shame, Self-Criticism, and Self-Compassion	PE-09	
46	Values, Meaning, and Personal Direction	PE-10	
47	Understanding Anger and Emotional Triggers as Functional Signals	PE-11	
48	Grief, Loss, and Non-Death Transitions	PE-12	
49	Loneliness and Meaningful Connection	PE-13	
50	Interpersonal Boundaries and Relationship Systems	PE-14	
51	Executive Dysfunction, Task Paralysis, and Motivation	PE-15	
52	Building Resilient Support Networks and Crisis Navigation	PE-16	
53	Relapse Prevention: Lapses, Relapses, and Recovery Curves	PE-17	
54	Stepping Down: Maintenance, Care Continuity, and Generalization	PE-18	

Extra topics for PHP

DAILY ROUTINES AND WELLNESS

55	Daily Rhythm Anchors	PH-WS-01	
56	Eating Routines, Access, and Daily Energy	PH-WS-02	
57	Building an Evening Wind-Down	PH-WS-03	
58	Daily Demands and Energy Pacing	PH-WS-04	
59	Medication Adherence and Prescriber Partnership	PH-WS-05	
60	Rest, Withdrawal, and What I Need	PH-WS-06	

SAFETY AND RELAPSE PLANNING

61	Deconstructing the Crisis Trajectory: Micro-Triggers and Prodromal Signs	PH-SP-01	
62	Internal Coping vs. Social Distraction	PH-SP-02	
63	Environmental Safety and Means Restriction	PH-SP-03	
64	The Anatomy of an Urge: Urge Surfing and Cognitive Decoupling	PH-SP-04	
65	Post-Lapse Cognitive Processing: Reducing the Abstinence Violation Effect	PH-SP-05	
66	Reviewing Safety-Plan Access, Contacts, and Gaps	PH-SP-06	

TRANSITION AND STEPPING DOWN

67	Questions About Levels of Care and Stepping Down	PH-TS-01	
68	Roles and Identity Beyond Treatment	PH-TS-02	
69	My Routine and Check-In Plan	PH-TS-03	
70	Outpatient Follow-Up and Handoff Questions	PH-TS-04	
71	Mixed Feelings About Leaving	PH-TS-05	
72	My Recovery Reference	PH-TS-06	

PRACTICE IN THE ROOM

73	Practicing a Request or Boundary	PH-AP-01	
74	Noticing Mild Body Sensations and Grounding	PH-AP-02	
75	Working With a Manageable Current Thought	PH-AP-03	
76	Taking a First Step in the Room	PH-AP-04	
77	Safety-Plan Access Practice	PH-AP-05	
78	Adapting a Skill for Daily Life	PH-AP-06	

Run safety and relapse planning topics only within your program's risk procedures. A group topic is not a risk assessment. Full session plans for every topic: **Mental Health Group Therapy Curriculum for IOP and PHP** (Thoughtkind Press). Three free sessions: thoughtkindpress.com/free-resources